the Army Public School, Dhaula Kuan, a huge school with over 6000 students and we wondered how the girls would adjust. We need not have worried though, as Isha met up with her old pal Aarti Kundalkar, friends since Golibar Maidan and Staff College days, and trotted off inside without a backward glance. Amala did have a bit of a problem finding her way around in such a big school, which had separate buildings for the primary, secondary and senior secondary wings, but she too adjusted in no time. Once the girls were settled, Veena too started scouting around and got a job at the Bloom Public School in Vasant Kunj itself. This made it possible for her to leave for school after the kids had left and come back about an hour before Isha and Amala returned. In a place like Delhi, it was a boon to have the workplace just a five-minute drive away. I think those were some of the best years, with the grandparents and grandchildren staying together and bonding strongly.

Col Agarwal was very happy to see me and brought me up to speed. On account of the peculiar nature of the operations, the Battalion was being shifted frequently, to wherever there was a crisis. By the time the Battalion could settle down, it was moved again. This, coupled with the fact that there was no permanent 2iC, meant that the CO had not been on leave for nearly a year, and so he was really looking forward to my arrival. Col Agarwal was even more than meticulous. He noted each and every point in a diary (a habit I copied) and once it went into his diary, it would remain there until it was fructified. There was no escaping it; it might be three weeks or three months later, but the point would not be struck off till it had reached a satisfactory conclusion. He was extremely meticulous in his planning, especially for the officers. For each officer, he had made an employment plan for the entire year that included a spot of leave every three months or so. One never had to ask

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